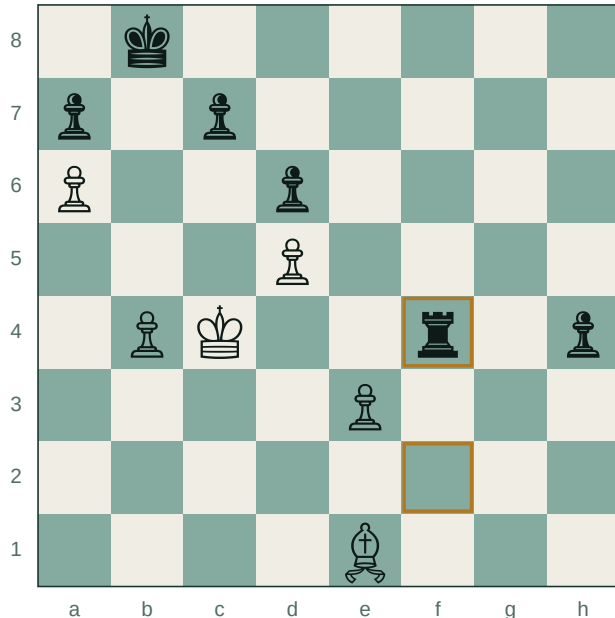


Active defensive resources: White, move 58

Active defensive resources

White to move



Previous move: 57...Rxf4+. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

58. exf4 h3 59. Bg3

58.exf4 The pawn captures the rook on f4. Recorded reply: **58...h3**.

59.Bg3 The bishop moves from e1 to g3.

At the end, nominal material is White 7 / Black 4 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +5: the balance goes from -2 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A defensive puzzle may aim to preserve equality rather than win. Judge success against the threat, not only the final material count.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

The best defense may create a threat, exchange an attacker, or change the geometry of the attack. Identify the opponent's concrete idea before selecting a response.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the threatened move and the conditions it requires. Look for a move that breaks one of those conditions with tempo.

The defending king is on b8. Geometrically undefended: rook on f4. Check for tactical protection.